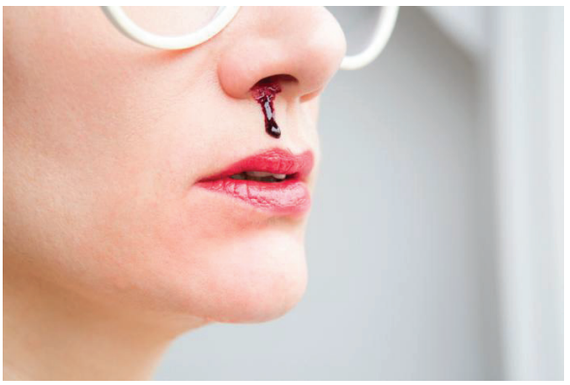
Vitamin K - Deficiency



Blood clotting



Bleeding in nose

Fig 11.7: Symptoms of Vitamin K deficiency

lettuce, cauliflower, cabbage, broccoli and liver.

Symptoms of Vitamin K deficiency

- Leads to increased tendency to hemorrhages.
- Defective blood clotting.
- Bleeding occurs in nose.
- Prothrombin levels are reduced.

11.3 Water Soluble Vitamins

Water soluble vitamins are soluble in water and so they cannot be stored in the body. Therefore, a day-to-day supply of these vitamins is essential.

The B vitamins have important metabolic roles as coenzyme partners with cell enzymes that control energy metabolism and build tissue. Eight vitamins are there in this group.

11.3.1 Vitamin B_1 (Thiamine)

Thiamine acts as a catalyst in the oxidation process which prepares glucose in the body to provide energy. Vitamin B_1 is a vital coenzyme for the metabolism of fats, carbohydrates and proteins. So, without B_1 the body cannot use the food to make energy. It is known as 'Appetite vitamin' and makes a person feel hungry.

Functions:

- Thiamine helps increase hunger. Thus aids normal growth.
- Thiamine controls mental and nervous fatigue, irritability and restlessness.
- Promotes growth, protects the heart muscle and stimulates brain action.
- The vitamin improves peristalsis and helps to prevent constipation.
- Improves circulation of blood and promotes a healthy skin.

Food Sources of Thiamine

Whole grain cereals, wheat, rice, oats, yeast, sunflower seeds, peanuts, Bengal gram, capsicum, turnip, beet, fish, liver, legumes, nuts, wheat germ, baked beans, whole grains enriched breads and cereals, egg etc.,

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